Spelling Patterns

u-e spelling pattern

1. Learn the words first. Make sure you know what each word means.
2. Test yourself by writing down each word correctly in the first column. Go over any mistakes.
3. Get someone to test you and write your answers in the second column. Go over any mistakes.

Look/Learn/Cover	Write/Check 1	Write/Check 2
u s e f u l		
a s s u m e		
c o s t u m e		
f o r t u n e		
p r o t r u d e		
c o n f u s e		
r e f u s e		
e n d u r e		
c l o s u r e		
p u r e		
s e c u r e		
h u g e		
a c c u s e		
a t t i t u d e		
a l t i t u d e		
i n c l u d e		
e x c l u d e		
p e r f u m e		
m u l e		
d u k e		
m u t e		
a s t u t e		
i n t r u d e		
a m u s e		
p l u m e		

Spelling Pattern Exercises

u-e spelling pattern

1. You should know these words. If you make any mistakes please go over them to ensure your learning is secure.
2. These exercises are designed to test the spellings you have learnt, check your understanding and further enhance your vocabulary.

Exercise 1 – CLOZE test.
Fill in the missing letters to make the correct words.

The Hungry Duke.

The tall gentleman walked into the **_ x _ l _ s _ ve** London restaurant wearing an open necked white shirt, a black cloak and a red hat with a **h _ g _ p l _ m _** of feathers **p _ o t r _ d _ n g** from the top. The doorman **r _ f _ s _ d** him entry on the grounds that he was not wearing a tie. Angry at being **e x _ l _ d _ d**, the man **f _ m _ d**, "I am not **a m _ s _ d**. I am the **D _ k _** of Essex, I am worth a **f _ _ t _ n _** and I **a _ s _ m _ d** that you would know me. I do not like your **a _ _ i t _ d e** and I do not own a tie anyway."

Exercise 2 – The words on the left are opposites of the words on the right. Complete the words on the right.

1. contaminated	_ _ r _	2. annoy	_ m _ s _
3. vocal	_ _ t e	4. beginning	_ _ o s _ r e

Exercise 3 – The words on the left mean the same or nearly the same as the words on the right. Complete the words on the right.

1. bulge	_ r o t _ _ d e	2. perspective	a t _ _ _ _ d _
3. tolerate	_ _ d _ r e	4. canny	_ s t _ t _

Exercise 4 – CLOZE sentences. Fill in the missing letters to complete each sentence.

1. I made my **_ _ r t _ n _** in India.
2. It is difficult to breathe at this **_ _ t i t _ d _**.
3. I don't wish to **_ _ t r _ d _** but I have important news.
4. By looking at your scowl I **_ s _ u m _** you don't like broccoli.
5. Please don't **_ _ c l _ d _** me from your game.

Opposites 1 - Revision

You have learnt these harder words now do the following exercises.

What is the opposite of descendant? _____

What is the opposite of barren? _____

What is the opposite of assemble? _____

Re-write these sentences using the opposite of the word in bold.

I want to return **home**.

I will have to **refuse** the invitation.

I have a very **modern** bicycle.

The boy's **absence** was noted in the school register.

Fill in the gaps on the right to find the opposite of the word on the left.

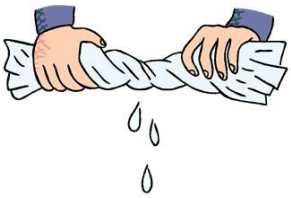
depart _____ ve

forward b _____ ward

straight b _ _ t

SCORE:

If you didn't get them all correct please revise Opposites 1.



Homophones

Some words are pronounced like other words
but are different in spelling and meaning, e.g. wring and ring.

Tick off each word as you learn it please.

Beat	To strike; to stir vigorously; to win; to overcome
Beet	A vegetable – like beetroot or sugar beet
Cell	A small room where a prisoner is held; part of a battery
Sell	To exchange something for money
Feat	A remarkable, skilful or daring action
Feet	Plural of foot
Mail	Posted letters; armour, e.g. chain mail
Male	Masculine - boys and men are males
Flower	A blossom
Flour	Ground grain, especially wheat, for baking
Hall	A large room e.g. your school hall
Haul	To drag something heavy with effort
Need	To be in want of
Knead	To work up dough ready for baking
Ring	The sound of a bell; a circle; a wedding ring, a key ring, a circus ring
Wring	To twist forcibly e.g water from a cloth
Time	Minutes, hours, days etc.
Thyme	A herb used in cooking
Yoke	Wooden frame for oxen; part of a garment
Yolk	Yellow part in the middle of an egg

Choose the correct word from the pair to complete each sentence:

1. The two oxen were joined together by a _____ so they could pull the plough. **yolk yoke**
2. It is difficult to separate the _____ from the white of the egg. **yolk yoke**
3. After your swimming lesson you should _____ out your costume. **ring wring**
4. The postman got up early to deliver his _____ on Christmas Eve. **mail male**
5. The prisoner prowled about his _____ regretting his actions. **cell sell**
6. To make a cake you need to _____ the sugar with the butter. **beat beet**
7. Mother added _____ to the casserole. **time thyme**
8. If he could just _____ his bike, he'd have enough money to buy a car. **sell cell**

Use one pair of words from the list to complete each of the sentences below:

9. The ship's crew _____ the heavy cargo from the ship to the customs _____ for inspection.
10. It is a _____ to run a marathon as your _____ get very sore after twenty-six miles.

HOM2

You should learn these off by heart.

C. Cathy Cook's school work for marking

My Mum saw an advetisement for a cloths shop offering the laitest fashons newly arived from Paris. The pichure was of a slim lady in a sedaite pose. In fact she was so thin her waste apeared to have evaporrated. She looked composed and confident but I thourght she also looked sad and lonley because she didnt smile. The model seemed to be saying, "You to could look like me if you borght this beutiful and expensive dress."

I did not like the dress and I would'nt want my Mum to look like her, but she imediately went round to the shop to try it on. It was hopeless. It did not fit her at all.

"I knew I shouldnt have eaten those scones, she said.

How many mistakes in spelling or grammar did you spot?

7 Plurals

Rule 4
For nouns ending in y after a vowel, just add s.

FOLD

1. day		days
2. alley		alleys
3. journey		journeys
4. jay		jays
5. motorway		motorways
6. storey		storeys
7. alloy		alloys
8. bay		bays
9. trolley		trolleys
10. tray		trays
11. key		keys
12. monkey		monkeys
13. jockey		jockeys
14. decoy		decoys
15. way		ways
16. buoy		buoys
17. ray		rays
18. abbey		abbeys
19. holiday		holidays
20. valley		valleys

SCORE 1st attempt | | 2nd attempt

8 Plurals

Exercise 4
Practise Rules 3 & 4.
Note the letter before y.

FOLD

1.	boy		boys
2.	lady		ladies
3.	chimney		chimneys
4.	duty		duties
5.	army		armies
6.	donkey		donkeys
7.	play		plays
8.	city		cities
9.	jockey		jockeys
10.	valley		valleys
11.	copy		copies
12.	toy		toys
13.	berry		berries
14.	journey		journeys
15.	trolley		trolleys
16.	country		countries
17.	pony		ponies
18.	baby		babies
19.	alley		alleys
20.	library		libraries

SCORE 1st attempt | | 2nd attempt

Paired reading 1: The Secret Garden by Frances Hodgson Burnett

CHAPTER IX
-THE STRANGEST HOUSE ANY ONE EVER LIVED IN-

The Secret Garden is a classic novel which follows the story of Mary Lennox, an orphan who moves into her uncle's mansion. With the help of an enthusiastic robin, Mary's curiosity results in her discovery of a secret garden which she is determined must be brought back to life. The following chapter sees Mary's excitement upon first entering the garden.

It was the sweetest, most mysterious-looking place any one could imagine. The high walls which shut it in were covered with the leafless stems of climbing roses which were so thick that they were matted together. Mary Lennox knew they were roses because she had seen a great many roses in India. All the ground was covered with grass of a wintry brown and out of it grew clumps of bushes which were surely rosebushes if they were alive. There were numbers of standard roses which had so spread their branches that they were like little trees. There were other trees in the garden, and one of the things which made the place look strangest and loveliest was that climbing roses had run all over them and swung down long tendrils which made light swaying curtains, and here and there they had caught at each other or at a far-reaching branch and had crept from one tree to another and made lovely bridges of themselves. There were neither leaves nor roses on them now and Mary did not know whether they were dead or alive, but their thin gray or brown branches and sprays looked like a sort of hazy mantle spreading over everything, walls, and trees, and even brown grass, where they had fallen from their fastenings and run along the ground. It was this hazy tangle from tree to tree which made it all look so mysterious. Mary had thought it must be different from other gardens which had not been left all by themselves so long; and indeed it was different from any other place she had ever seen in her life.

"How still it is!" she whispered. "How still!"

Then she waited a moment and listened at the stillness. The robin, who had flown to his treetop, was still as all the rest. He did not even flutter his wings; he sat without stirring, and looked at Mary.

"No wonder it is still," she whispered again. "I am the first person who has spoken in here for ten years."

She moved away from the door, stepping as softly as if she were afraid of awakening someone. She was glad that there was grass under her feet and that her steps made no sounds. She walked under one of the fairy-like gray arches between the trees and looked up at the sprays and tendrils which formed them. "I wonder if they are all quite dead," she said. "Is it all a quite dead garden? I wish it wasn't."

If she had been Ben Weatherstaff she could have told whether the wood was alive by looking at it, but she could only see that there were only gray or brown sprays and branches and none showed any signs of even a tiny leaf-bud anywhere.

But she was inside the wonderful garden and she could come through the door under the ivy any time and she felt as if she had found a world all her own.

The sun was shining inside the four walls and the high arch of blue sky over this particular piece of Misselthwaite seemed even more brilliant and soft than it was over the moor. The robin flew down from his tree-top and hopped about or flew after her from one bush to another. He chirped a good deal and had a very busy air, as if he were showing her things. Everything was strange and silent and she seemed to be hundreds of miles away from any one, but somehow she did not feel lonely at all. All that troubled her was her wish that she knew whether all the roses were dead, or if perhaps some of them had lived and might put out leaves and buds as the weather got warmer. She did not want it to be a quite dead garden. If it were a quite alive garden, how wonderful it would be, and what thousands of roses would grow on every side!

Her skipping-rope had hung over her arm when she came in and after she had walked about for a while she thought she would skip round the whole garden, stopping when she wanted to look at things. There seemed to have been grass paths here and there, and in one or two corners there were alcoves of evergreen with stone seats or tall moss-covered flower urns in them.

As she came near the second of these alcoves she stopped skipping. There had once been a flowerbed in it, and she thought she saw something sticking out of the

black earth—some sharp little pale green points. She remembered what Ben Weatherstaff had said and she knelt down to look at them.

"Yes, they are tiny growing things and they might be crocuses or snowdrops or daffodils," she whispered.

She bent very close to them and sniffed the fresh scent of the damp earth. She liked it very much.

"Perhaps there are some other ones coming up in other places," she said. "I will go all over the garden and look."

She did not skip, but walked. She went slowly and kept her eyes on the ground. She looked in the old border beds and among the grass, and after she had gone round, trying to miss nothing, she had found ever so many more sharp, pale green points, and she had become quite excited again.

"It isn't a quite dead garden," she cried out softly to herself. "Even if the roses are dead, there are other things alive."

She did not know anything about gardening, but the grass seemed so thick in some of the places where the green points were pushing their way through that she thought they did not seem to have room enough to grow. She searched about until she found a rather sharp piece of wood and knelt down and dug and weeded out the weeds and grass until she made nice little clear places around them.

"Now they look as if they could breathe," she said, after she had finished with the first ones. "I am going to do ever so many more. I'll do all I can see. If I haven't time today I can come tomorrow."

She went from place to place, and dug and weeded, and enjoyed herself so immensely that she was led on from bed to bed and into the grass under the trees. The exercise made her so warm that she first threw her coat off, and then her hat, and without knowing it she was smiling down on to the grass and the pale green points all the time.

The robin was tremendously busy. He was very much pleased to see gardening begun on his own estate. He had often wondered at Ben Weatherstaff. Where gardening is done all sorts of delightful things to eat are turned up with the soil. Now here was this new kind of creature who was not half Ben's size and yet had had the sense to come into his garden and begin at once.

Mistress Mary worked in her garden until it was time to go to her midday dinner. In fact, she was rather late in remembering, and when she put on her coat and hat, and picked up her skipping-rope, she could not believe that she had been working two or three hours. She had been actually happy all the time; and dozens and dozens of the tiny, pale green points were to be seen in cleared places, looking twice as cheerful as they had looked before when the grass and weeds had been smothering them.

"I shall come back this afternoon," she said, looking all round at her new kingdom, and speaking to the trees and the rose-bushes as if they heard her.

Then she ran lightly across the grass, pushed open the slow old door and slipped through it under the ivy. She had such red cheeks and such bright eyes and ate such a dinner that Martha was delighted.

"Two pieces o' meat an' two helps o' rice puddin'!" she said. "Eh! mother will be pleased when I tell her what th' skippin'-rope's done for thee."

In the course of her digging with her pointed stick Mistress Mary had found herself digging up a sort of white root rather like an onion. She had put it back in its place and patted the earth carefully down on it and just now she wondered if Martha could tell her what it was.

"Martha," she said, "what are those white roots that look like onions?"

"They're bulbs," answered Martha. "Lots o' spring flowers grow from 'em. Th' very little ones are snowdrops an' crocuses an' th' big ones are narcissuses an' jonquils and daffydowndillys. Th' biggest of all is lilies an' purple flags. Eh! they are nice. Dickon's got a whole lot of 'em planted in our bit o' garden."

"Does Dickon know all about them?" asked Mary, a new idea taking possession of her.

"Our Dickon can make a flower grow out of a brick walk. Mother says he just whispers things out o' th' ground."

"Do bulbs live a long time? Would they live years and years if no one helped them?" inquired Mary anxiously.

"They're things as helps themselves," said Martha. "That's why poor folk can afford to have 'em. If you don't trouble 'em, most of 'em'll work away underground

for a lifetime an' spread out an' have little 'uns. There's a place in th' park woods here where there's snowdrops by thousands. They're the prettiest sight in Yorkshire when th' spring comes. No one knows when they was first planted."

"I wish the spring was here now," said Mary. "I want to see all the things that grow in England."

She had finished her dinner and gone to her favourite seat on the hearth-rug.

"I wish—I wish I had a little spade," she said. "Whatever does tha' want a spade for?" asked Martha, laughing. "Art tha' goin' to take to diggin'? I must tell mother that, too."

Mary looked at the fire and pondered a little. She must be careful if she meant to keep her secret kingdom. She wasn't doing any harm, but if Mr. Craven found out about the open door he would be fearfully angry and get a new key and lock it up forevermore. She really could not bear that.

"This is such a big lonely place," she said slowly, as if she were turning matters over in her mind. "The house is lonely, and the park is lonely, and the gardens are lonely. So many places seem shut up. I never did many things in India, but there were more people to look at—natives and soldiers marching by—and sometimes bands playing, and my Ayah told me stories. There is no one to talk to here except you and Ben Weatherstaff. And you have to do your work and Ben Weatherstaff won't speak to me often. I thought if I had a little spade I could dig somewhere as he does, and I might make a little garden if he would give me some seeds."

Martha's face quite lighted up.

"There now!" she exclaimed, "if that wasn't one of th' things mother said. She says, 'There's such a lot o' room in that big place, why don't they give her a bit for herself, even if she doesn't plant nothin' but parsley an' radishes? She'd dig an' rake away an' be right down happy over it.' Them was the very words she said."

"Were they?" said Mary. "How many things she knows, doesn't she?"

"Eh!" said Martha. "It's like she says: 'A woman as brings up twelve children learns something besides her A B C. Children's as good as 'rithmetic to set you findin' out things.'"

"How much would a spade cost—a little one?" Mary asked.

"Well," was Martha's reflective answer, "at Thwaite village there's a shop or so an' I saw little garden sets with a spade an' a rake an' a fork all tied together for two shillings. An' they was stout enough to work with, too."

"I've got more than that in my purse," said Mary. "Mrs. Morrison gave me five shillings and Mrs. Medlock gave me some money from Mr. Craven."

"Did he remember thee that much?" exclaimed Martha.

"Mrs. Medlock said I was to have a shilling a week to spend. She gives me one every Saturday. I didn't know what to spend it on."

"My word! that's riches," said Martha. "Tha' can buy anything in th' world tha' wants. Th' rent of our cottage is only one an' threepence an' it's like pullin' eye-teeth to get it. Now I've just thought of somethin'," putting her hands on her hips.

"What?" said Mary eagerly.

"In the shop at Thwaite they sell packages o' flower-seeds for a penny each, and our Dickon he knows which is th' prettiest ones an' how to make 'em grow. He walks over to Thwaite many a day just for th' fun of it. Does tha' know how to print letters?" suddenly.

"I know how to write," Mary answered.

Martha shook her head.

"Our Dickon can only read printin'. If tha' could print we could write a letter to him an' ask him to go an' buy th' garden tools an' th' seeds at th' same time."

"Oh! you're a good girl!" Mary cried. "You are, really! I didn't know you were so nice. I know I can print letters if I try. Let's ask Mrs. Medlock for a pen and ink and some paper."

"I've got some of my own," said Martha. "I bought 'em so I could print a bit of a letter to mother of a Sunday. I'll go and get it." She ran out of the room, and Mary stood by the fire and twisted her thin little hands together with sheer pleasure.

"If I have a spade," she whispered, "I can make the earth nice and soft and dig up weeds. If I have seeds and can make flowers grow the garden won't be dead at all—it will come alive."

She did not go out again that afternoon because when Martha returned with her pen and ink and paper she was obliged to clear the table and carry the plates and dishes downstairs and when she got into the kitchen Mrs. Medlock was there and told her to do something, so Mary waited for what seemed to her a long time before she came back. Then it was a serious piece of work to write to Dickon. Mary had been taught very little because her governesses had disliked her too much to stay with her. She could not spell particularly well but she found that she could print letters when she tried. This was the letter Martha dictated to her: "My Dear Dickon:

This comes hoping to find you well as it leaves me at present. Miss Mary has plenty of money and will you go to Thwaite and buy her some flower seeds and a set of garden tools to make a flower-bed. Pick the prettiest ones and easy to grow because she has never done it before and lived in India which is different. Give my love to mother and every one of you. Miss Mary is going to tell me a lot more so that on my next day out you can hear about elephants and camels and gentlemen going hunting lions and tigers.

"Your loving sister,
Martha Phoebe Sowerby."

-Please answer the questions on the following page-

Questions

The following words are all underlined in the text above:

Immense **Smothering** **Fearfully** **Cheerful**

Delightful **Exclaimed** **Mysterious**

Loveliest

Pondered **Eagerly**

Particularly **Sheer** **Awakening**

Obliged **Wonderful**

Forevermore

Anxious **Excited**

Tremendous **Troubled**

1) In the boxes labelled A-E, write down a word from the box above which correctly matches the following definitions

A		**very great in amount scale or intensity**
B		**you are required to do something**
C		**very pleasant and charming**
D		**feeling or showing worry or nerves**
E		**to think about something carefully**

2) For the following five sentences, pick a word from the box above to complete the sentence so that it makes sense

It was not a _____ sunny day, so the children did not go to the beach.

There was a look of _____ panic on his face as he dropped his phone.

Rebecca put the pancakes on her plate before _____ them in maple syrup.

Gary _____his disbelief that his team had lost the match.

The husband told his wife he would love her _____ .

3) Using the clues given, unscramble the following anagrams to find a word from the box above

A) **misemen**

Clue: This word means extremely large or great, especially in scale or degree

B) **earfulfly**

Clue: Synonyms for this word include: apprehensively, nervously and timidly

C) **chefrule**

Clue: Antonyms of this word include: miserable, sad or unhappy

D) **grayeel**

Clue: This word means you are keen or desire to do something

E) **evilestlo**

Clue: Synonyms of this word include beautiful, captivating and alluring

4) The following sentences all have a gap, choose a word from the box to fill the gap in each sentence. Write the sentence out correctly.

a) Beth was so for her birthday party that she couldn't sit still .

b) Robert slammed the door loudly, his family to his return.

c) The old man was by the news of his wife's unhappiness.

d) The man had a look in his eyes.

e) Reeve thought that her grandma was the most woman.

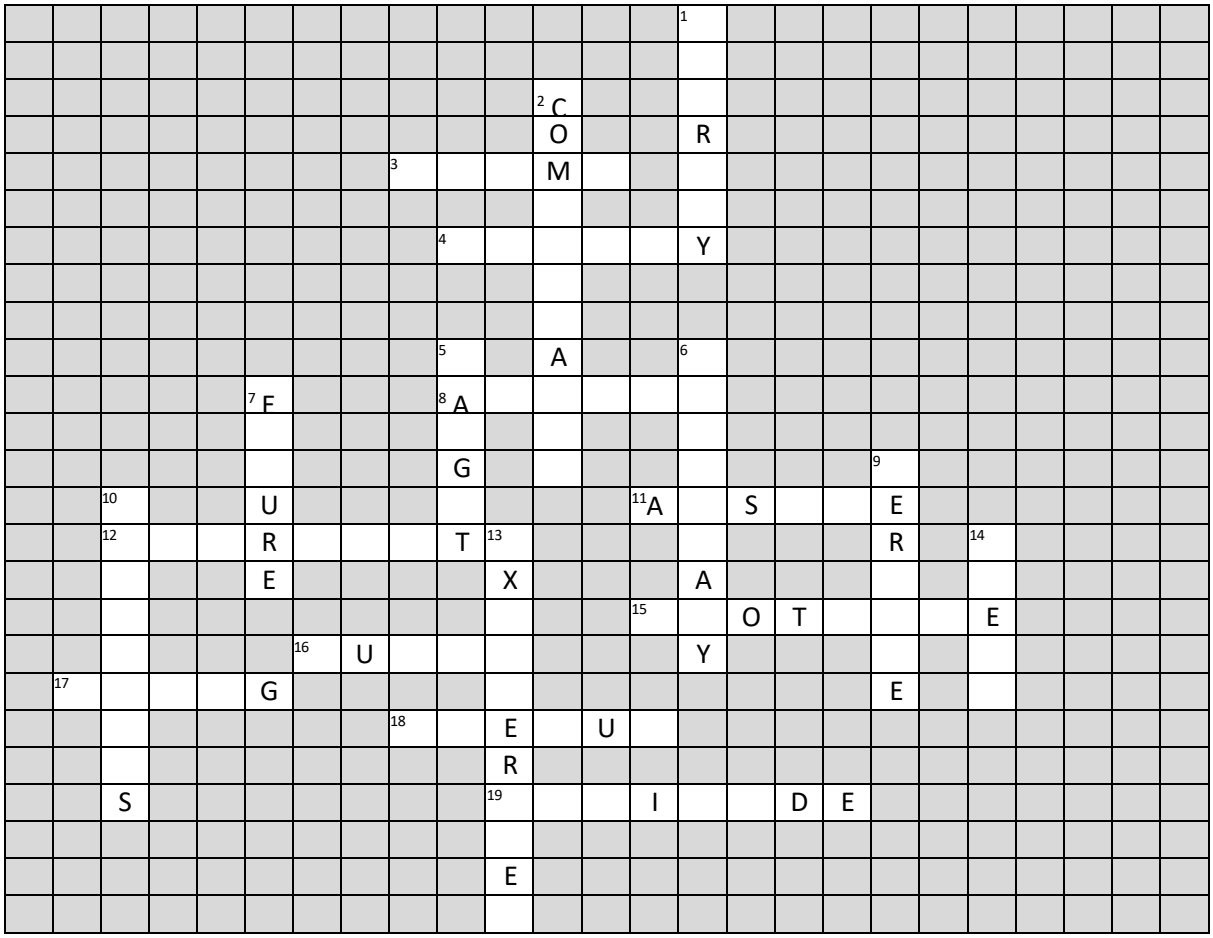
Revision Anagrams – Jumbled Letters

- This exercise uses words you have recently learnt.
- Use the clues to help you sort the letters out to find the answer.
- If you are not sure of a word (spelling or meaning) add it to your own personal vocabulary list.

Question	Clue	Answer
1. cruelso	The opposite of opening.	
2. elmup	An arrangement of feathers or a cloud of smoke.	
3. keyjoc	A person who rides a horse.	
4. cadye	Similar to rotting.	
5. rudetin	Going somewhere where you are unwanted or uninvited.	
6. seucac	To suggest that someone has done something.	
7. latitude	The height of something above the sea or ground level.	
8. mendor	Something that is quite new.	
9. keyo	Something that attaches ploughs to animals.	
10. cometus	You might dress up in this to perform a play.	
11. turfone	A large sum of money.	
12. freeus	The opposite of agree.	
13. focusen	Making something harder to understand.	
14. rescue	To make something safe.	
15. usame	To make someone find something funny.	

Crossword Revision Puzzle

You have recently learnt all these words. Use the clues to solve the puzzle. Please revise any you are not sure of.



Clues down

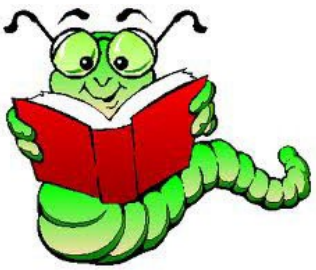
1. The act of travelling from one place to another.
2. Difficult to analyse or understand.
5. The past tense of 'catch'.
6. Something that is absolutely essential or needed.
7. To continue in a certain way for a long time.
9. A toiletry that emits and diffuses a fragrant odour.
10. Rooms where lots of books are kept.
13. Greatly annoyed and out of patience.
14. You do this with bread dough to mix the ingredients. Sounds like need.

Clues across

3. A plant with leaves used as seasoning. Sounds like time.
4. Long areas of low land in the earth's surface.
8. Being intelligent.
11. Accepting something without proof.
12. Containing many details and small parts.
15. Bulge outward.
16. These float on the surface of water.
17. To twist and squeeze. Sounds like ring.
18. Being of use or service.
19. Values and thoughts that affect one's behaviour.

CR/4

Cloze Text Introduction



Cloze type comprehension questions come in two formats; in the first one you will be shown a story. In various places in the story words will have had letters removed; your challenge is to fill in the blanks.

This is a test of the breadth of your vocabulary, your ability to think quickly and clearly and your spelling.

1. **Background work** – This is one of the CEM tests where there is very little technique that can help you. Most of any improvement you can make will come from reading to aid vocabulary development (for at least half an hour a day- more if you can) and from going through the Synonyms, Opposites, Plurals, Homophones and Homographs and Spelling work we provide, learning both meaning and spelling as you go.

It is never too late to start building a wider vocabulary. There is no magic solution for success with these tests other than having a wide vocabulary and good spelling.

2. **Process - How to work -** Remember that these exercises are designed to test your vocabulary and comprehension ability. You will know most of the vocabulary you are being asked to complete.

You must use your comprehension ability to complete the words. Remember that the story should provide you with lots of help. If you genuinely can't complete a word then move on but come back to it. The answer may come to you later.

Now try the following short test – once you have had a first go at the test then read the further technique development notes.

Romulus and Remus

Fill in the gaps. This is a cloze type exercise.

King Numitor was king of Alba Longa, but his wicked **b r _ _ _ e r** Amulius seized the throne from him and **_ i _ _ e d** the king's male **h _ _ r s.** Then Numitor's daughter gave birth to royal **t _ _ _ s,** called Romulus and Remus. As soon as Amulius **f o _ _ d** out, he had the babies **t h _ _ _ n** into the River Tiber in a basket.

He hoped they **w _ _ _ d** drown so that he could **r e _ _ _ n** ruler, but they were **r e s _ _ e d** by a she-wolf called Lupa who heard their **c r _ _ _.** She fed the babies with her own **m _ _ k** and cared for them. When they grew into **b _ _ s** they were found and taken in by a **s h _ p _ e r _,** Faustulus, and his wife. The twins, **i _ n _ _ _ n t** of their true origins, **p r _ _ _ d** to be natural leaders and they both **g _ _ _ e d** many followers.

When they discovered the truth of their royal birth they **k i _ _ _ d** Amulius and restored Numitor to his **r i g _ _ f _ l** throne. Rather than wait to inherit Alba Longa, the twins decided to **b _ _ _ d** a new city for themselves and their **f o _ l _ _ _ r s.**

While they were building the new city the two brothers **a _ g _ _ d** with each other about who **s h _ _ _ d** be king. Romulus killed Remus with a **h _ _ _ y** stone. Romulus became the first king of the city he named after himself - Rome.

Marks /23

Remember, to improve your cloze performance you need to broaden your vocabulary through reading. Read for at least half an hour per day. Don't worry if you don't get 100%. No one will know every word.

Cloze passages technique development

ONLY READ THIS AFTER YOUR FIRST ATTEMPT AT ROMULUS AND REMUS

Major improvement with these types of questions can only come from enlarging your vocabulary and improving your spelling.

However we can also help you to approach the questions correctly to give yourself the best chance of getting as many marks as you can.

Once you have been through a passage for the first time and got the easy words you then need to approach the difficult words in a different way.

REVIEW AND BUILD

Firstly, it is essential that children are prepared for the fact that they may only instantly get a few words on first pass. It is also the case that even experienced children need a little while to 'click' with each test.

After the first pass, children will often find that new ideas and thoughts have come to them because some of the gaps have been filled in. Children should then review the text and fill in any new words that come to them before applying the technique detailed below.

ACTIVE THINKING

Core technique - In all cases if the word doesn't come to you immediately you must start thinking more **ACTIVELY**. What this means is that you cannot just sit and stare at the blanks hoping the word will come to you, you must go through some steps to help you uncover the answer.

Here's an example from the second line:

Amelius seized the throne from him and **_ _ _ led** the king's male **h _ _ rs.**

Cloze passages technique development

Step 1 – Think about the story. What we have to do if the words don't naturally come to us is to think more deeply about the context, **think about what is happening in the story.** You must also read a few lines afterwards as there are sometimes clues there.

We know from the opening line that Amelius and Numitor were not good friends, we know Amelius seized Numitor's throne, so whatever happens next must be connected.

If you were stealing a King's throne what would you do I wonder? Would you want to secure your throne? What might you do to secure it? You'd want your own children to succeed you. What could you do to help them? These are the type of questions you should be asking yourself, they help get to the correct answer.

In this case having seized the throne the next thing on Amelius' mind was securing his future by **killing** the male **heirs** so there would be no future challenge to his own place as King or that of his children. So the answer to the example above would be **killed** and **heirs**.

Step 2 - Look at the type of word and what you are given. Sometimes you are given a beginning part of the word - **Un** or **Dis** or **Re**. It sometimes helps to focus on this and think about all those words you know which have the same beginning.

The same is true of endings. If for instance you are given **_ _ g** as the last three letters then this might indicate that the ending is **ING**. This may help. If the ending is **_ _ d**, the ending might be **ED**. You can try this for all common word endings.

Step 3 - Always write out your words. It is very easy if you just use the answer sheet to make a spelling error. You should always write out your words separately and then fill in the answer only when you are sure.

Cloze passages technique development

Step 4 - Watch out for different forms of pronunciation. As an example let's look at the word **sh _ phe _ d** from the text. In this case the mistake would be to imagine the word must be made with an **F** sound for the **PH** in the middle. In fact it isn't. The answer is **shepherd.**

Step 5 - Trial and error. If, and only if, you have time and have answered absolutely every other question on the text and in that part of the test you can try to work more methodically. **This is a last resort because it is a very long process.** Only do this if you have no other option.

To do this you take a word and try to fill in the blanks through trial and error. Very occasionally this will help you.

For instance, from the text there is the word **pr _ _ _ d**. You could start by guessing the ending might be **ED**. Then you could try the letter A in the third letter place to see if anything came to you. With luck when you get to the letter **O** you will leap to answer which is **PROVED**. Only use this as a **VERY** last resort.

N.B. In some cases our CLOZE passages have included words which we do not expect pupils to get without resorting to the trial and error technique. This has been done to ensure pupils try the technique and initially focus on those words they can get rather than stalling.

REMEMBER……

- Expect to have to work at it; the answers will not come instantly.
- Work actively; do not just stare at the page hoping an answer will come.
- Do a first pass and fill in those words you instantly know.
- Do a second pass and do any new words that come to you, remembering to use the information in the text and the sentences before and afterwards to help you.
- Think about the context very carefully there are often lots of clues there to help you.
- Use word endings and word beginnings to try to help prompt your vocabulary memory.
- Only use the trial and error technique as a very last resort.

ABOVE ALL ELSE WORK ACTIVELY AND DO NOT FREEZE

Perseus and Medusa - Snakes Alive!

In ancient Greece, on the island of Seriphos, there lived a brave young man called Perseus. King Polydectes wanted to marry Perseus' mother Danae, but she hated the King and Perseus protected her from him. To solve the problem this cruel tyrant planned to get rid of Perseus. He set him the task of killing Medusa and bringing back her head. Medusa was a Gorgon monster, a hideous creature with sharp teeth and with hair made of snakes. Anyone who looked at her was turned to stone.

Perseus was the son of Zeus, the most important of the gods. So Perseus was given gifts by the gods to help him complete his task and return safely. He was given a shiny shield by Athene and a sharp sword from Hermes. Another god gave Perseus a helmet to protect him and winged sandals to help him fly.

"Take care," said the goddess Athene as she gave him the shield. "You must never look directly at Medusa or you will be turned to stone. Look only at her reflection in this shield."

Perseus flew into the mountains and found Medusa's gloomy cave. He crept inside and advanced slowly and steadfastly. Suddenly he heard a hissing sound as Medusa came round the corner. From her ghastly head the snakes stretched out with forked tongues, seeking their prey. Perseus had his shield ready and he held it so he could see Medusa's reflection in the shiny surface. He was horrified by the monster he saw there. With one powerful blow of his sword he cut off her head and it rolled across the floor. Keeping his eyes tightly shut, Perseus grasped the monstrous head and put it in his sack. He then flew back to the palace. King Polydectes was shocked to see Perseus unharmed, carrying a sack. Perseus carefully looked away as he tipped the head onto the floor. The king glanced at the head of Medusa and sealed his fate. His heart stopped, and he was turned to stone.

This was how Perseus was able to free his mother.

True or False?

Read the text carefully and tick those sentences that are **True:**

1. Danae and King Polydectes were married.
2. King Polydectes sent Perseus to kill Medusa.
3. Medusa was a beautiful goddess with golden hair.
4. If you looked directly at Medusa you would be turned to stone.
5. Athene and Hermes were gods.
6. Medusa lived in a fine palace.
7. Athene had snakes writhing around her head.
8. Hermes gave Perseus a helmet.
9. Perseus used his shield as a mirror to save himself.
10. Perseus' father and mother were Zeus and Danae
11. Zeus was a minor god
12. Perseus killed Medusa by strangling her.
13. King Polydectes took one look at Danae and turned to stone.
14. Medusa was one of the Gorgon monsters.
15. Perseus needed help from the gods to kill Medusa.
16. The snakes on Medusa's head made no sound.
17. Athene explained to Perseus how the shiny shield could protect him.
18. Polydectes was a gentle king.
19. Seriphos was on the Greek mainland.
20. The winged sandals allowed Perseus to fly.

ANSWERS - COMPLETE VOCABULARY – PART 4

Opposite 1 Revision

ancestor
fertile
dismantle/disperse

I want to go abroad.
I will have to accept the invitation.
I have a very ancient bicycle.
The boy's presence was noted in the school register.

arrive
backward
bent

Homophones

1. yoke
2. yolk
3. wring
4. mail
5. cell
6. beat
7. thyme
8. sell
9. haul, hall
10. feat, feet

Revision Anagrams

closure
plume
jockey
decay
intrude
accuse
altitude
modern
yoke
costume
fortune
refuse
confuse
secure
amuse

Crossword Revision Puzzle

Down

1. Journey
2. Complicated
5. Caught
6. Necessary
7. Endure
9. Perfume
10. Libraries
13. Exasperated
14. Knead

Across

3. Thyme
4. Valley
8. Astute
11. Assume
12. Intricate
15. Protrude
16. Buoys
17. Wring
18. Useful
19. Attitude

Spelling Letter Patterns

Exercise 1

The tall gentleman walked into the **EXCLUSIVE** London restaurant wearing an open necked white shirt, a black cloak and a red hat with a **HUGE** **PLUME** of feathers **PROTRUDING** from the top. The doorman **REFUSED** him entry on the grounds that he was not wearing a tie. Angry at being **EXCLUDED** the man **FUMED**, "I am not **AMUSED**. I am the **DUKE** of Essex, I am worth a **FORTUNE** and I **ASSUMED** that you would know me. I do not like your **ATTITUDE** and I do not own a tie anyway."

Exercise 2

1. Pure
2. Amuse
3. Mute
4. Closure

Exercise 3

1. Protrude
2. Attitude
3. Endure
4. Astute

Exercise 4

1. Fortune
2. Altitude
3. Intrude
4. Assume
5. Exclude

Find the Mistakes - C

mum advertisement clothes
My Mum saw an advetisement for a cloths shop offering
latest fashions arrived picture
the laitest fashons newly arived from Paris. The pichure
sedate
was of a slim lady in a sedaite pose. In fact she was so
waist appeared evaporated
thin her waste apeared to have evaporrated. She looked
thought
composed and confident but I thourght she also looked sad
lonely didn't
and lonley because she didnt smile. The model seemed to

too bought
be saying, "You to could look like me if you borght this
beautiful
beutiful and expensive dress."
wouldn't mum
I did not like the dress and I would'nt want my Mum to
immediately
look like her, but she imediately went round to the shop to

try it on. It was hopeless. It did not fit her at all.
shouldn't scones,"
"I knew I shouldnt have eaten those scones, she said.

Paired Reading

1.
a) tremendous
b) obliged
c) delightful
d) anxious
e) pondered

2.
particularly
sheer
smothering
exclaimed
forevermore

3.
a) immense
b) fearfully
c) cheerful
d) eagerly
e) loveliest

4.
Beth was so excited for her birthday party that she couldn't sit still.
Robert slammed the door loudly, awakening his family to his return.
The old man was troubled by the news of his wife's unhappiness.
The man had a mysterious look in his eyes.
Reeve thought that her grandma was the most wonderful woman.

Romulus and Remus

King Numitor was king of Alba Longa, but his wicked **brother** Amulius seized the throne from him and **killed** the king's male **heirs**. Then Numitor's daughter gave birth to royal **twins**, called Romulus and Remus. As soon as Amulius **found** out he had the babies **thrown** into the River Tiber in a basket. He hoped they **would** drown so that he could **remain** ruler, but they were **rescued** by a she–wolf called Lupa who heard their **cries**. She fed the babies with her own **milk** and cared for them. When they grew into **boys** they were found and taken in by a **shepherd** Faustulus, and his wife. The twins, **ignorant** of their true origins **proved** to be natural leaders and they both **gained** many followers. When they discovered the truth of their royal birth they **killed** Amulius and restored Numitor to his **rightful** throne. Rather than wait to inherit Alba Longa, the twins decided to **build** a new city for themselves and their **followers**. While they were building the new city the two brothers **argued** with each other about who **should** be king. Romulus killed Remus with a **heavy** stone. Romulus became the first king of the city he named after himself - Rome.

Snakes Alive Comprehension Exercise

Only the following sentences are true – 2, 4, 5, 9, 10, 14, 15, 17, 20.